You will work in groups of three to investigate and visualize AI infrastructure as a physical, material, and planetary system. This task what exists behind the “cloud” and consists of two interconnected components:

1. Infrastructural Process
2. Planetary Consequence

Infrastructural Process:

You must investigate and visualize the infrastructural system that enables AI services, including (but not limited to): data centers, GPU clusters, server racks, network routing systems, cooling systems, energy supply chains, geographic distribution, etc.

Your visualization must clearly separate system layers, explain how data flows and compute is allocated, show where cooling operates, show how energy enters the system, and clarify what is invisible to users.

Planetary Consequence:

You then extend the infrastructural process outward to reveal planetary grounding, including (but not limited to): electricity sources and grid dependence, carbon emissions, water consumption, heat discharge, rare-earth extraction, hardware lifecycle and waste, land use, etc.

Your visualization must:

- Show resource inputs and environmental outputs
- Demonstrate how infrastructure is physically grounded
- Include temporal dimension (immediate vs accumulative effects)
- Make clear that the “cloud” is planetary

1 x “Understanding AI Infrastructure” A1 Landscape Poster (Group 10%)
Due: Friday, 20 March 2026, 22:00

Completion